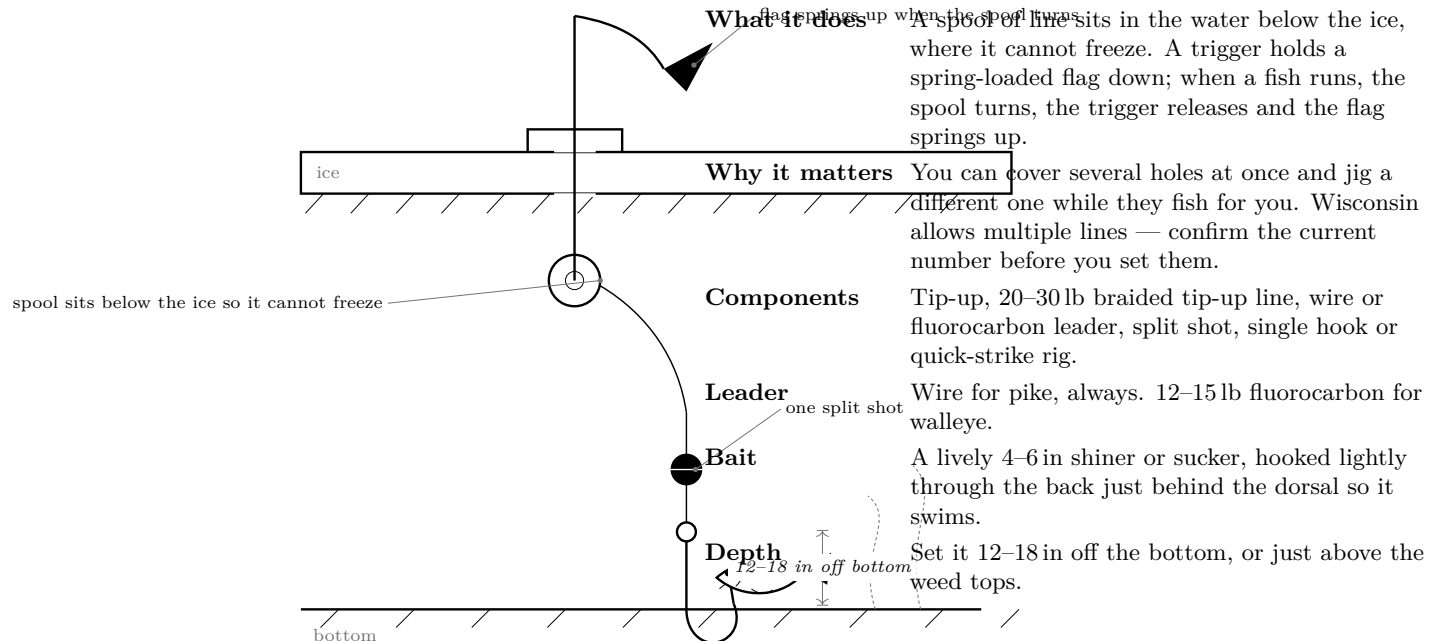


Tip-Up

Winter pike and walleye

Fish live bait under the ice while you fish somewhere else



Set it

1. Drill the hole and clear the slush completely, or the flag will freeze down and never trip.
2. Drop the baited rig until it touches bottom, then reel up 12–18 in and mark that line depth with a rubber band or a clip so you can reset the same depth all day.
3. Set the trigger with the flag bent under it. Test it once by hand — a trigger set too tight will not release for a fish.
4. Bank snow around the base of the tip-up to keep the hole from refreezing.

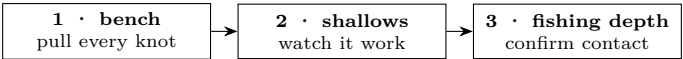
When the flag goes

Walk, do not run	Footsteps on clear ice carry. Approach quietly, especially in shallow water.
Watch the spool	If it is still turning, the fish is moving. Let it run. If it has stopped, wait until it starts again — that is the fish turning the bait.
Set by hand	Pick the line up off the spool, take up slack until you feel the fish, and pull firmly hand over hand. There is no rod to absorb a snap, so a smooth strong pull is correct.
Bring it up hand over hand	Lay line on the ice away from the hole so it cannot tangle back down.
Where	Pine spots 1 , 6 and 9 over weed edges in 8–15 ft; North spots 1 and 5 . Pike season closes 7 March — check the current dates.

ICE IS NEVER GUARANTEED

No ice is safe ice. Check thickness yourself as you go rather than trusting somebody else's report; four inches of clear ice is a common minimum for one person on foot, and more for a group. Springs, inlets, outlets and current thin the ice unpredictably — on North Lake the river inflow and outflow at spots **2** and **6** are exactly the places to stay off. Carry ice picks around your neck, take a rope, and do not go out alone.

Prove the rig



- Bench test

Pull leader and hook knots, cycle the spool and trip arm ten times, and verify the flag releases without line drag.
- Water test

In the hole, lower the bait just below view: it must swim freely while the spool turns without sticking.
- Proof at depth

Sound depth with a clip-on weight, then set bait a measured 1–3 ft above bottom and record the arm-length reference.
- If it fails

False flags: reduce trigger sensitivity or shelter from wind. No spool turn on a run: clear ice and line overlap before resetting. Change one variable, repeat the same cast or drop, and keep the first setting that restores the expected proof.

Record the adjustment

Try	Depth / distance	Sink count	Observed action	Fish response	Next single change
1					
2					
3					

Questions before another cast

Did the rig reach the intended depth? What visible line, rod-tip, bottom, or lure response proves that? Did the connection and hook point survive the retrieve? Was a follow, bite, snag, or refusal observed rather than assumed? Name one variable to change and one to hold constant. If the observation cannot answer those questions, repeat the same short controlled cast before changing the setup.

☐ Sketch the cast: surface, cover, target depth, line angle, and where the response occurred

Evidence-based verdict

☐ repeat unchanged

☐ alter one variable

☐ retire or repair the rig

Reason and next prediction

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